

Who counts as a teacher

Occupation of the longest job held last year, CPS ASEC — three Census classifications, 28 survey years

Surveys 1998-2002

teaching years 1997-2001

1990 Census classification

Surveys 2003-2019

teaching years 2002-2018

2002/2010 Census classification (SOC)

Surveys 2020-2025

teaching years 2019-2024

2018 Census classification (SOC 2018)

155	Teachers, prekindergarten and kindergarten	2300	Preschool and kindergarten teachers	2300	Preschool and kindergarten teachers
156	Teachers, elementary school†	2310	Elementary and middle school teachers†	2310	Elementary and middle school teachers†
157	Teachers, secondary school†	2320	Secondary school teachers	2320	Secondary school teachers
158	Teachers, special education	2330	Special education teachers	2330	Special education teachers
159	Teachers, n.e.c. (not elsewhere classified)	2340	Other teachers and instructors	2360	Other teachers and instructors

Never included (they carry their own codes, outside the set): postsecondary teachers (2200s) · tutors (2350, 2018 cl.)
teaching assistants (2540/2545) · childcare workers (4600) · education administrators (0230)

Are the codes traceable across census years?

- Yes

as a block: the K-12 teaching group maps one-to-one across the three classifications. Every figure uses the union of the codes, never a sub-code across regimes.
- †

sub-codes are not: middle-school teachers sit under elementary or secondary before 2003 and with elementary (2310) after; “other teachers” is renumbered 2340 → 2360 in 2020.
- Yes

within each survey: last year’s job (OCCUP) and the current job (PEIOOCC) share one classification, so no leaver/switch comparison straddles a code change (seam surveys: 2003 and 2020).
- Yes

for people, but only two years: the CPS links the same person across two consecutive March interviews (PERIDNUM), never longer.